Final Approach

The design system for a top-down air traffic game that looks like a box of toys tipped onto a lawn.

FOUNDATIONS

Principles

1

Outline everything

Every drawn shape carries a thick outline stroke with round joins. No hairlines, no shape without an edge.

2

Flat and bright

Fills are single flat colours. No gradients or textures. Only things that fly get a soft shadow.

3

Toy scale

Sizes are exaggerated, not realistic. A jumbo is nearly twice a light prop.

4

Silhouette before colour

Types, zones and states are told apart by shape first. Colour confirms.

5

The field stays clear

UI lives in small outlined chips at the edges. Nothing covers a landing zone.

FOUNDATIONS

Colour

59 colour tokens in two themes. The world is lawn, asphalt and white aircraft; the UI lives in the sky; sun yellow is the signature. Swatches follow the theme switch; values list Day first.

Ink and edges

outline
#1d2545
night #0a0e24
The thick cartoon outline on every drawn shape: aircraft, runways, buttons, panels, HUD chips. Never pure black. Also the colour of hard lip shadows.

ink
#1d2545
Primary text and icons on surface, surface-raised and surface-sunken. The same in both themes: panels stay paper-light at night.

ink-muted
#4f5a7c
Secondary text, captions and hints on surface, surface-raised and surface-sunken.

on-accent
#1d2545
Text and icons on any bright fill: sun, tangerine, cherry, success, sky-500, star and every path colour. Dark in both themes because the fills stay bright.

on-outline
#fffaf0
Text and icons on an outline-coloured fill: coach marks, tooltips, the callsign tag.

on-sky
#1d2545
night #f6f2e4
Text and icons placed straight on bg-sky, sky-100 or sky-300, outside any panel: menu titles, version line.

on-sky-muted
#2f3b63
night #b5bfdd
Secondary text straight on bg-sky, sky-100 or sky-300.

Sky and surfaces

bg-sky
#8fd3fb
night #151c40
Background of menus and every non-gameplay screen. The sky the UI lives in.

sky-100
#e6f6ff
night #1c2654
Quietest backdrop tint on bg-sky: far cloud bank, sunburst rays on menus. Text on it is on-sky.

sky-300
#a9defc
night #2b3a82
Backdrop stripes and near cloud bank on bg-sky. Text on it is on-sky.

sky-500
#4db8f5
night #5aa8f0
Secondary button fill, info status, active toggle track. Text on it is on-accent.

sky-700
#1668ad
Links and emphasised text on surface and surface-raised; lip under sky-500 fills.

surface
#fffaf0
night #efe9d8
Panels, dialogs, level cards and HUD chips. Paper-light in both themes so the outline always reads.

surface-raised
#ffffff
night #fffaf0
A surface sitting on a surface: toggle knobs, the selected segment, score popups.

surface-sunken
#e2eefa
night #cfd6ea
Wells and tracks: toggle track, segmented control trough, empty life slots, locked level art.

Airfield

bg-field
= grass-500
Background of the gameplay viewport: the airfield lawn.

grass-300
#b4e36a
night #5aa57c
Light mowing stripe and grass tufts on the field.

grass-500
#7fcf4b
night #3f8a66
Base lawn colour of the airfield.

grass-700
#5cb337
night #327559
Dark mowing stripe, taxiway verge, bushes.

grass-900
#3b8a2a
night #1f5443
Hedge and tree shade; grass detail next to asphalt.

asphalt-300
#939cb0
night #7a84a6
Runway shoulder and apron wear.



asphalt-500

#6a7389

night #5e6788

Runway, taxiway and helipad surface.



asphalt-700

#474f63

night #454d6b

Tyre marks and the touchdown zone on the runway.



marking

#ffffff

night #eef2fb

Runway centre line, threshold bars, numbers and the helipad H, on asphalt-500 and asphalt-700.



marking-warn

#ffd23f

Helipad ring and hold-short lines, on asphalt-500 and asphalt-700.

Accents



sun

#ffcb3d

Primary button fill, score, warning status. The game's signature yellow. Text on it is on-accent.



sun-deep

#e39a12

Lip and pressed shade under sun fills.



tangerine

#ff8f33

Streak badge, highlights, second aircraft livery. Text on it is on-accent.



tangerine-deep

#d9641a

Lip and pressed shade under tangerine fills.



cherry

#ff5d52

Lives, destructive buttons, collision alerts. Text on it is on-accent.



cherry-deep

#c9302c

Lip and pressed shade under cherry fills.

Flight paths and liveries













path-1

= sun

Flight path and livery of the 1st aircraft on screen. Path colours are assigned in order and reused once an aircraft lands.

path-2

= tangerine

Flight path and livery, 2nd aircraft.

path-3

= cherry

Flight path and livery, 3rd aircraft.

path-4

#ff7ac8

Flight path and livery, 4th aircraft. Bubblegum.

path-5

#b48cff

Flight path and livery, 5th aircraft. Grape.

path-6

#4fe0e6

Flight path and livery, 6th aircraft. Lagoon.

Status

success

#35d6b0

Safe landing, valid landing zone glow, confirmations. A teal, not a green, so it reads on the lawn and stays apart from cherry for colour-blind players. Always paired with a check icon or a word. Text on it is on-accent.

success-ink

#0b6b59

Success text on surface and surface-raised.

danger

= cherry

Collision, miss, wrong landing zone. Always paired with a warning icon or a word.

danger-ink

#b3221f

Danger text on surface and surface-raised.

warning

= sun

Near-miss warning ring between two aircraft.

info

= sky-500

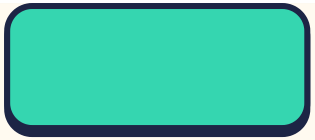
Neutral hints: next-aircraft arrow, tutorial pulses.



focus

#ffffff

Inner band of the two-tone focus ring: 3px focus, then 3px outline outside it. One of the two bands always holds 3:1 against whatever the ring lands on.



zone-ok

= success

Glow on a runway or helipad while the path end is a valid landing.



zone-no

= cherry

Glow on a landing zone of the wrong type for the selected aircraft.

Aircraft and sky objects



fuselage

#fdfcf5
night #f1f3fa

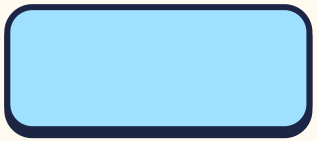
Aircraft body white.



fuselage-shade

#d5dbe8
night #b4bcd2

Engines, nacelles and the shaded side of the fuselage.



glass

#9fe0ff
night #8fd0ff

Cockpit windows. Keep them big.



glass-shine

#ffffff

The single highlight streak on a cockpit window.



prop-blur

rgba(29, 37, 69, 0.3)
night rgba(223, 230, 245, 0.3)

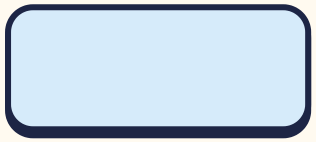
Translucent disc of a spinning rotor.



cloud

#ffffff
night #a9b5d6

Ambient drifting clouds above the field, drawn at opacity-cloud.



cloud-shade

#d6ebfa
night #7f8cb3

Underside of clouds.



shadow-ground

rgba(24, 40, 30, 0.28)
night rgba(4, 7, 18, 0.5)

The soft shadow an aircraft or cloud casts on the ground.



select-ring

#ffffff
night #ffe98a

Dashed ring around the selected aircraft. Always drawn over an outline-coloured casing, like the flight path.



star

#ffe066

Star burst on a safe landing; streak sparkles.



poof

#f7f8fc
night #dfe4f2

Comic poof cloud on a collision.



poof-shade

#c8d1e6
night #9aa5c4

Shaded lobes of the poof.



scrim

`rgba(17, 24, 58, 0.55)`
`night rgba(3, 5, 16, 0.7)`

Dims the field behind the pause and game-over dialogs.

FOUNDATIONS

Type

DynaPuff for headers, titles, buttons and the score. Inconsolata for regular text, labels and readouts.

Display · DynaPuff

Final Approach

display-xl · 72px/68px · 700 · -0.01em — The game title on the splash and main menu only.

Game over

display-lg · 48px/48px · 700 — Dialog headlines: Paused, Game over, Cleared to land.

Nice landing!

display-md · 36px/40px · 700 — Screen titles and the final score.

12 450

score · 32px/32px · 700 — The live score in the HUD and score popups. Thin space as thousands separator.

Titles · DynaPuff

Choose an airport

title-lg · 28px/32px · 600 — Section headings in menus.

Meadow Field

title-md · 22px/28px · 600 — Card titles, level names.

Sound effects

title-sm · 18px/24px · 600 — Settings rows, small headings.

Take off

button-label · 18px/20px · 600 — Labels of medium and large buttons.

Retry

button-label-sm · 15px/18px · 600 — Labels of small buttons, segments and chips.

Text · Inconsolata

Tap an aircraft, then drag to draw its path.

body-lg · 18px/28px · 500 — Tutorial copy and dialog lead text.

Planes land on runways. Helicopters land on helipads.

body · 16px/24px · 500 — All regular text. Never lighter than 500: thin strokes look weak beside the outlines.

Two aircraft got too close.

body-sm · 14px/20px · 500 — Supporting text in cards and toasts.

Best 18 200

caption · 12px/16px · 600 — Metadata under titles.

Readouts · Inconsolata

x3 STREAK

readout · 20px/24px · 800 — Numbers that change while you watch: streak multiplier, countdowns, stats.

NEXT UP

label · 13px/16px · 800 · 0.08em — Uppercase eyebrow labels above HUD values and settings groups. Write them in capitals.

FA 204

callsign · 12px/14px · 800 · 0.04em — The tag that follows a selected aircraft. Uppercase letters and digits.

FOUNDATIONS

Shape and depth

Spacing

TOKEN	VALUE	SCALE	USE
space-1	4px		Gap between an icon and its label; hearts in the lives meter.
space-2	8px		Inner padding of chips and HUD pills; gap between segments.
space-3	12px		Gap between HUD items; small button padding.
space-4	16px		HUD inset from the screen edge; card padding; default gap.
space-5	24px		Panel padding; gap between dialog buttons and copy.
space-6	32px		Dialog padding; gap between menu sections.
space-7	48px		Vertical rhythm on the main menu.
space-8	64px		Title block offset on splash and game over.

Radius

TOKEN	VALUE	CORNER	USE
`radius-sm`	8px		Chips, callsign tag, small tiles.
`radius-md`	14px		Buttons, icon buttons, HUD chips.
`radius-lg`	22px		Panels and level cards.
`radius-xl`	32px		Dialogs.
`radius-pill`	999px		Toggles, the streak badge, score popups, path dash caps.

Lines and flight path

TOKEN	VALUE	STROKE	USE
`line-1`	2px		Detail strokes inside a shape: window shine, runway dashes, grass tufts.
`line-2`	3px		Outline of small UI: chips, toggles, icons at 24px.
`line-3`	4px		The default outline: aircraft, buttons, panels, runways.

TOKEN	VALUE	STROKE	USE
line-4	6px		Outline of display type and of dialogs.
path-stroke	8px		Width of the coloured flight path dash.
path-casing	14px		Width of the outline-coloured casing drawn under the flight path.
path-dash	18px		Dash length of the flight path.
path-gap	16px		Gap between flight path dashes.
path-dot	22px		Diameter of the end dot of a flight path.

Shadows

TOKEN	VALUE	DEPTH	USE
shadow-lip-sm	0 3px 0 #1d2545		Hard lip under chips and small buttons. No blur: this is the toy-block edge.
shadow-lip	0 5px 0 #1d2545		Hard lip under buttons and HUD chips. Pressing a control collapses it to shadow-lip-sm and moves the control down by the difference.
shadow-lip-lg	0 8px 0 #1d2545		Hard lip under panels, cards and dialogs.
shadow-soft	0 10px 0 rgba(29, 37, 69, 0.16)		Second, translucent lip that grounds a dialog on the scrim.

TOKEN	VALUE	DEPTH	USE
shadow-float	6px 10px 6px rgba(24, 40, 30, 0.28)		The soft ground shadow of anything airborne: aircraft, clouds, score popups. Offset down-right, as if the sun sits top-left.
shadow-well	inset 0 3px 0 rgba(29, 37, 69, 0.14)		Inner top edge of sunken wells: toggle track, segmented trough.

Sizes

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
touch-min	48px	Minimum touch target for any control.
touch-aircraft	72px	Minimum pick diameter around an aircraft, however small it is drawn.
hud-chip	56px	Height of HUD chips and icon buttons in the HUD.
button-sm	40px	Height of small buttons (48px touch target with its margin).
button-md	52px	Height of default buttons.
button-lg	64px	Height of the main menu call to action.
icon-sm	20px	Icons inside chips and small buttons.
icon-md	28px	Icons inside buttons and HUD chips.
icon-lg	40px	Icons in coach marks and empty states.
sprite-light-prop	56px	Drawn size of the light prop at 1x viewport scale.

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
sprite-helicopter	64px	Drawn size of the helicopter, rotor disc included.
sprite-turboprop	68px	Drawn size of the turboprop.
sprite-jet	72px	Drawn size of the jet.
sprite-jumbo	104px	Drawn size of the jumbo. Exaggerated on purpose.

Opacity

TOKEN	VALUE	SAMPLE	USE
opacity-disabled	0.45		Disabled controls and locked levels.
opacity-cloud	0.85		Ambient clouds, so aircraft stay readable beneath them.
opacity-path-idle	0.7		Paths of aircraft that are not selected.
opacity-ghost	0.5		The straight-on projection drawn past a path end.

Layers

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
`z-field`	0	Lawn, runways, helipads, ground decoration.
`z-zone`	10	Landing zone glows.
`z-path`	20	Flight paths and end dots.
`z-ground-shadow`	30	Aircraft shadows, all below every aircraft.
`z-aircraft`	40	Aircraft, selection ring, callsign tag.
`z-fx`	50	Star bursts, poofs, score popups.
`z-clouds`	60	Ambient clouds.
`z-hud`	70	HUD and coach marks.
`z-overlay`	80	Scrim and dialogs.

FOUNDATIONS

Motion

Bouncy and short. Things arrive with one overshoot, controls snap, and the world never stops moving a little.

Easing

TOKEN	VALUE	FEEL	USE
`ease-bounce`	`cubic-bezier(0.34, 1.56, 0.64, 1)`		Anything arriving: pop-ins, dialog drop, selection ring. Overshoots once.
`ease-snap`	`cubic-bezier(0.2, 0.9, 0.3, 1)`		State changes of controls: press, toggle, segment slide.
`ease-out-soft`	`cubic-bezier(0.16, 1, 0.3, 1)`		Things leaving or fading: score popups rising, poof clearing.
`ease-sway`	`cubic-bezier(0.45, 0, 0.55, 1)`		Ambient back-and-forth: windsock, idle bob.

Duration

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
`dur-press`	`90ms`	Button press and release.
`dur-quick`	`160ms`	Toggles, segment changes, selection ring appearing.

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
dur-pop	280ms	Pop-in of chips, popups and coach marks.
dur-land	420ms	Squash-and-stretch on touchdown before the aircraft disappears.
dur-burst	600ms	Star burst and comic poof.
dur-dialog	360ms	Dialog drop-in.
dur-rotor	240ms	One rotor or propeller revolution. Linear, endless.
dur-march	900ms	One dash-length of flight path marching towards the end dot.
dur-sway	2400ms	One windsock wave.
dur-drift	48s	A cloud crossing the viewport.

BRAND

App icon

The sun-yellow jet climbing off the mown lawn, trailing its dashed flight path. Built only from system parts.



Rounded preview



Android adaptive, circle



Android adaptive, squircle



iOS mask

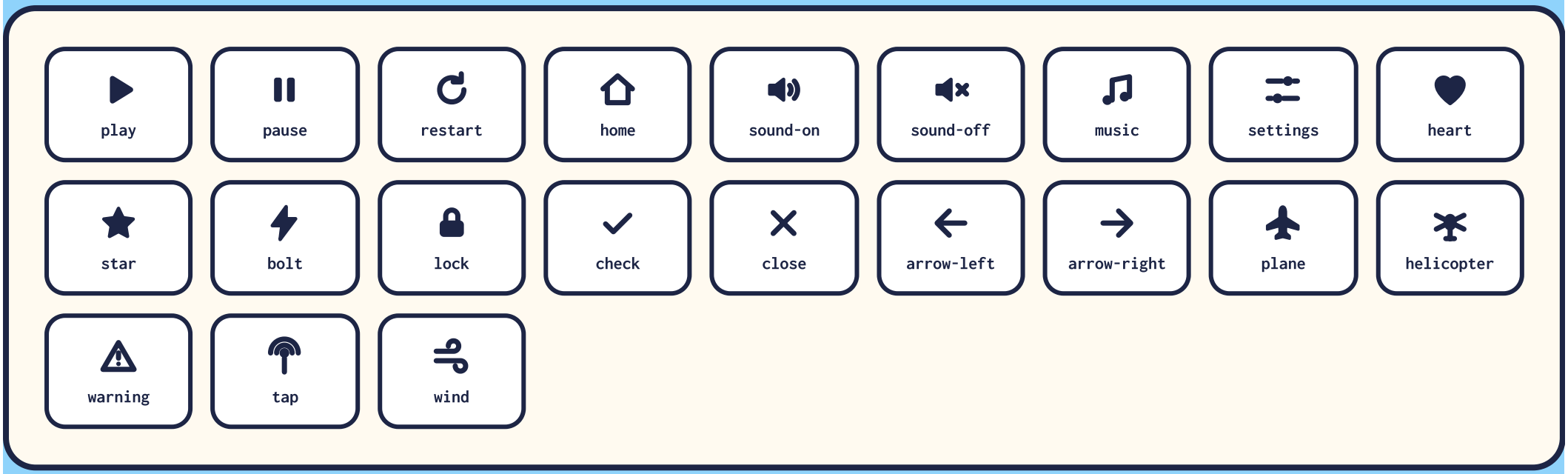


64 and 40px

ASSETS

Icons

21 glyphs on a 24px grid with 3px round strokes. They take the text colour.



ASSETS

Aircraft

Five flying toys on a 96-unit square. Drawn size grows with how hard each is to handle.

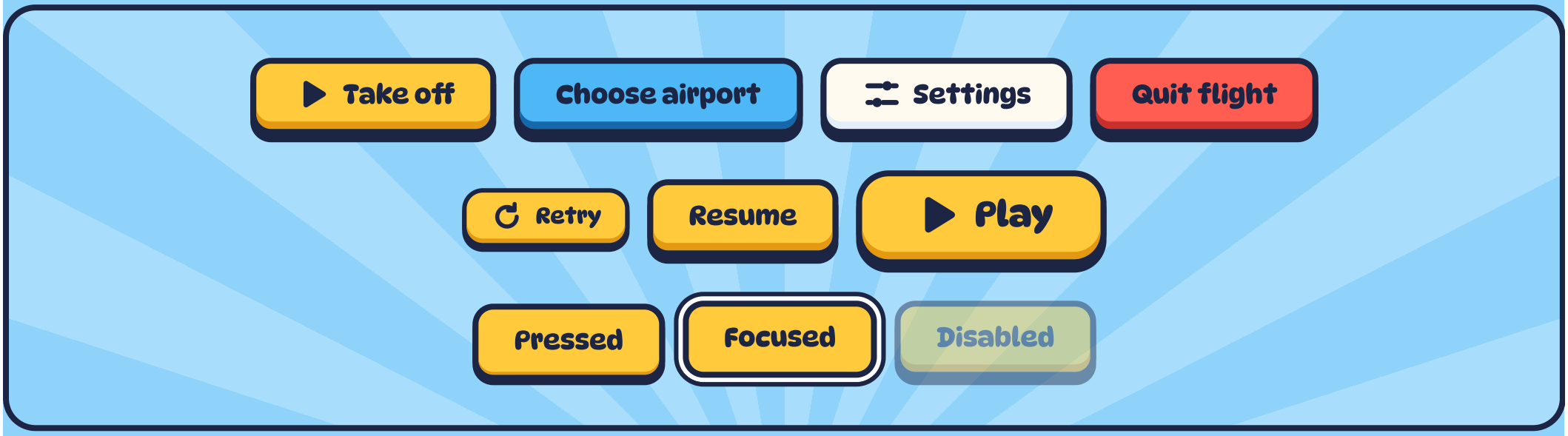
SPRITE	TYPE	SPEED	TURN RATE	LANDS ON	DRAWN SIZE
	**Light prop**	Slow	High	Runway	**56px**
	**Turboprop**	Medium	Medium	Runway	**68px**
	**Jet**	Fast	Low	Runway	**72px**
	**Jumbo**	Medium-fast	Very low	Runway	**104px**
	**Helicopter**	Slow	Very high	Helipad	**64px**

Components

Actions

Button

The chunky toy-block button for every text action in menus and dialogs.



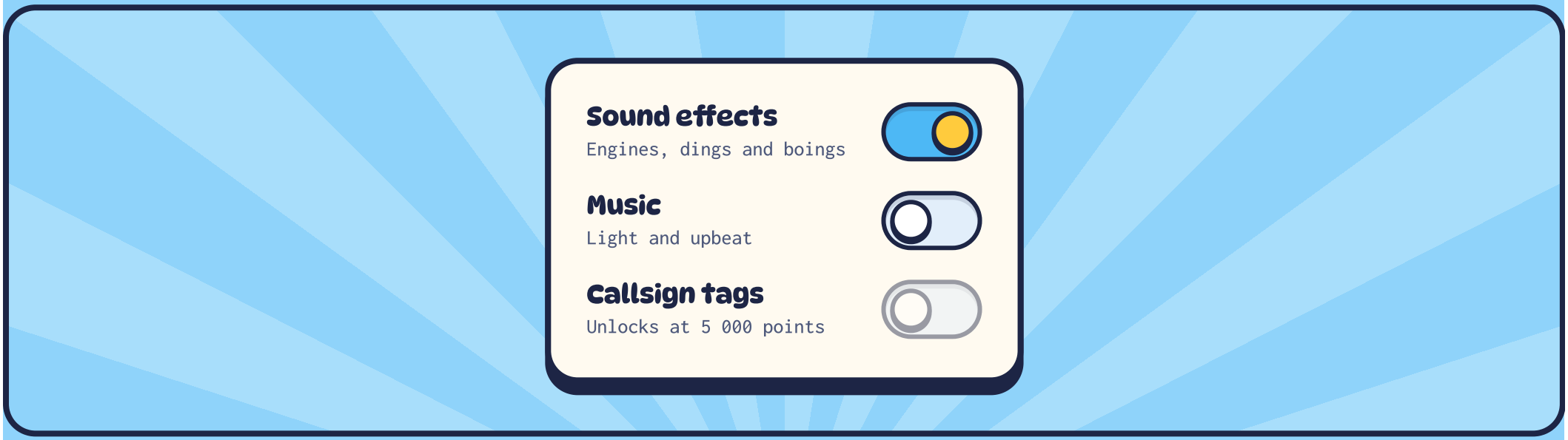
Icon Button

A square button that carries one icon and no text, used in the HUD and for close and back.



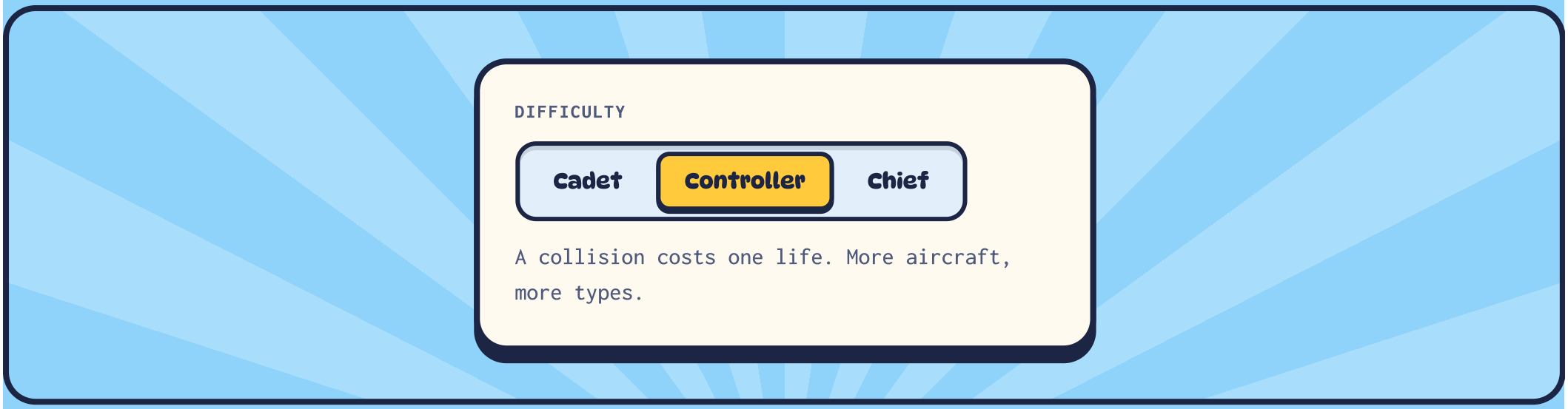
Toggle

An on/off switch for settings that apply immediately.



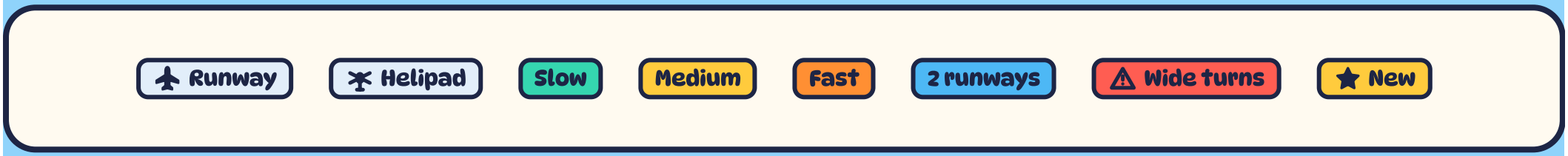
Segmented Control

A row of two to four mutually exclusive choices, one always selected.



Chip

A small outlined tag that names a property: aircraft type, speed class, landing zone, lock state.



HUD

Hud Bar

The gameplay overlay: score and streak on the left, next aircraft, lives and pause on the right.



Score Counter

The live score in a HUD chip.



Lives Meter

Remaining lives as a row of hearts.



Next Aircraft Hint

A HUD chip that previews the next aircraft and the edge it will enter from.



Streak Badge

A tilted pill that shows the current landing streak multiplier.



Score Popup

A short-lived pill that rises from the place something happened on the field.



World

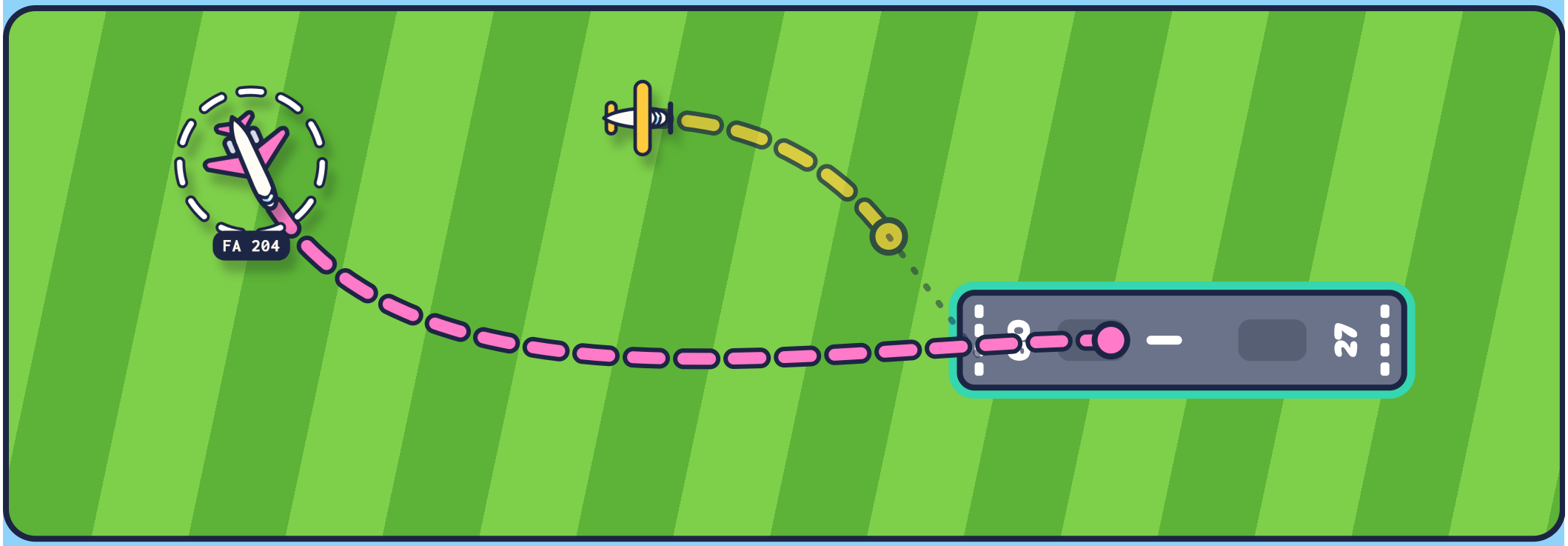
Aircraft

The five flying toys, drawn top-down with the nose pointing up at heading 0.



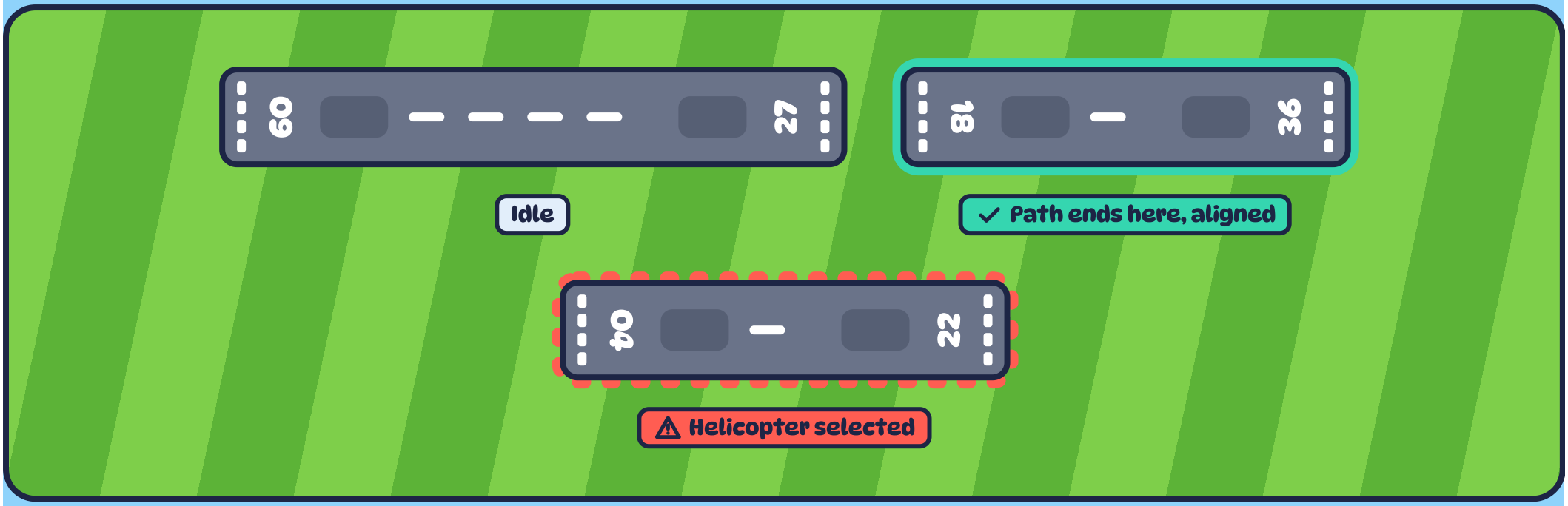
Flight Path

The dashed line a player draws from an aircraft to where it should go.



Runway

A landing strip for airplanes, defined by position, heading, length and its two numbers.



Helipad

A round landing spot for helicopters.



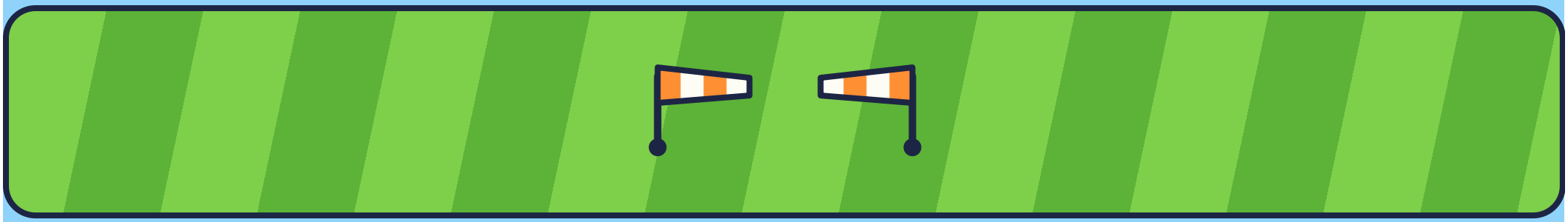
Cloud

An ambient cloud that drifts across the field above the aircraft.



Windsock

A striped windsock beside the runway, waving.



Effects

The three feedback animations that tell the player what just happened.



Menus

Panel

A paper-light container for grouped content in menus.

How to play



Tap an aircraft to select it.



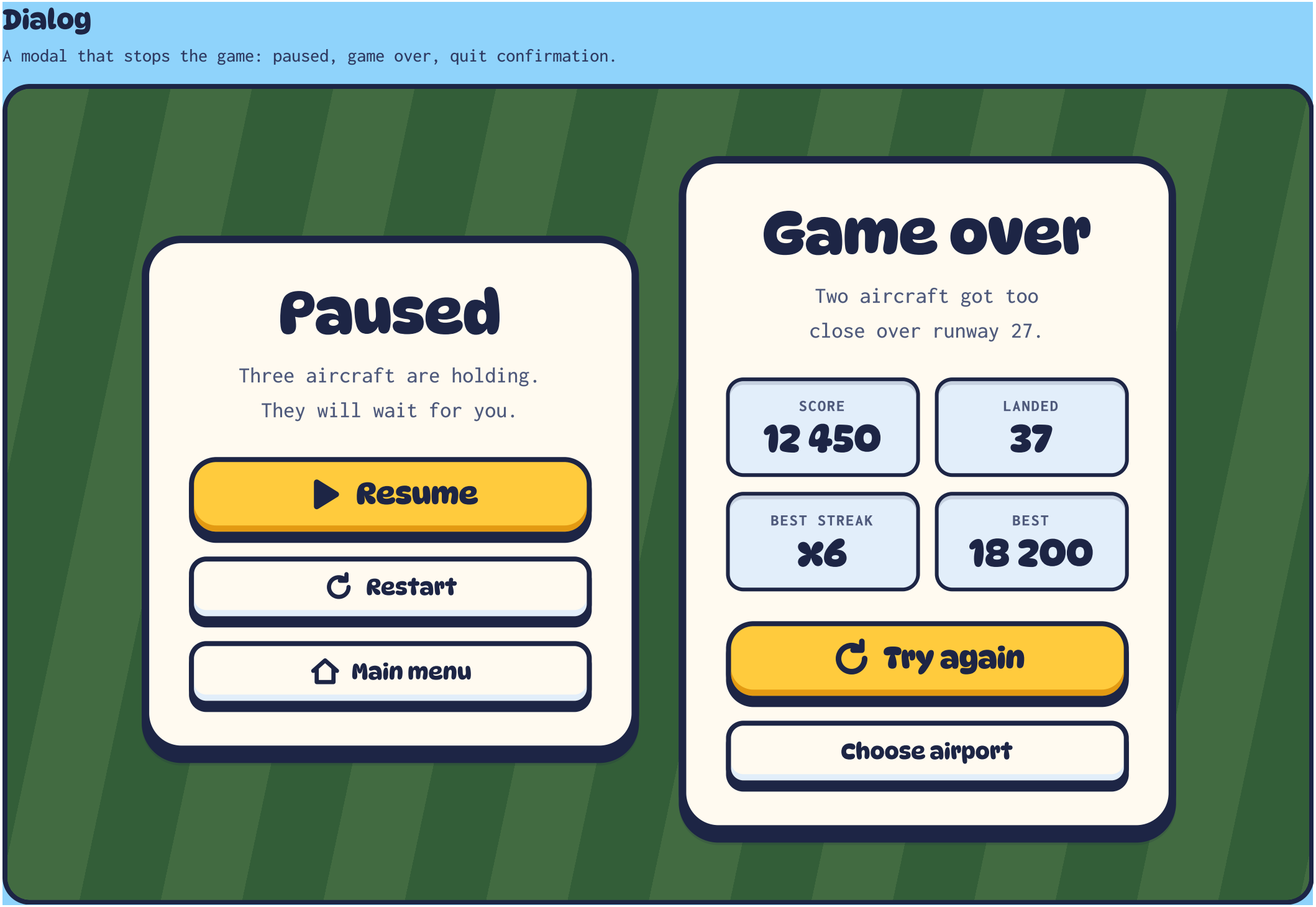
Drag to a runway. Planes need to line up with it.



Helicopters land on the H.

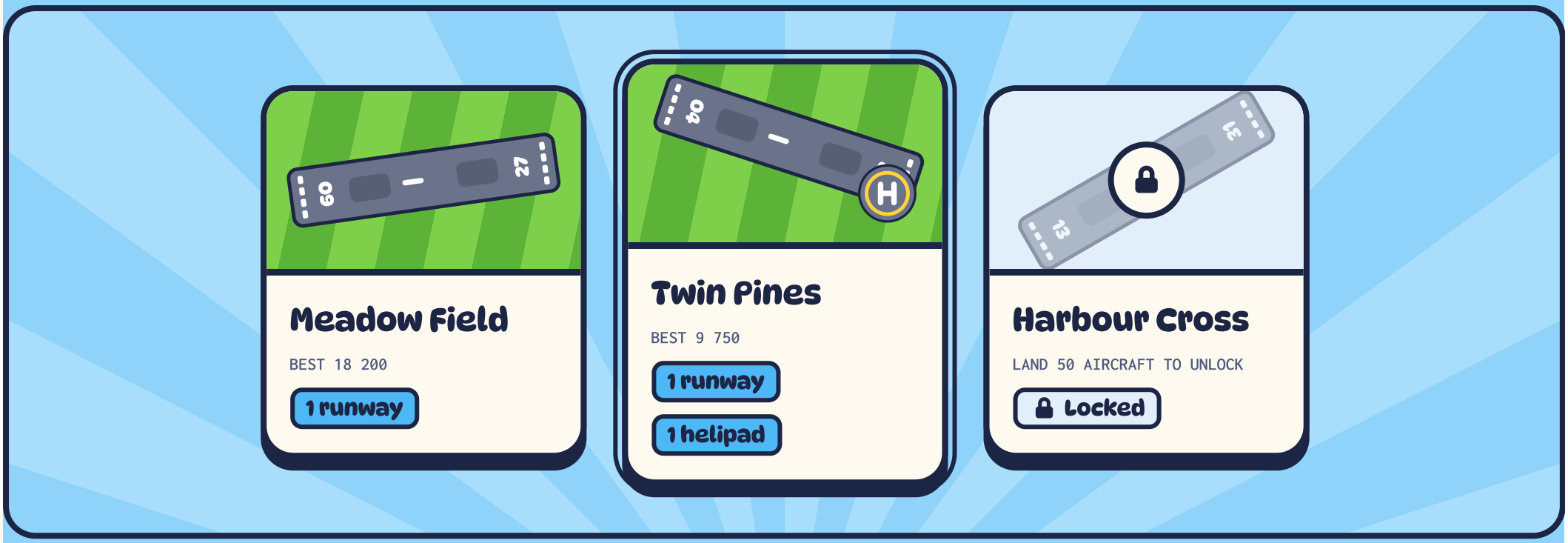
Dialog

A modal that stops the game: paused, game over, quit confirmation.



Level Card

A selectable card for one airport layout.



Coach Mark

A dark speech bubble that teaches one gesture at a time.



Wordmark

The game's name set in DynaPuff, outlined and tilted.



REFERENCE COMPOSITIONS

Screens

Game Screen

A reference composition of a game in progress, showing how every world and HUD piece layers.



Main Menu

A reference composition of the main menu on the sky backdrop.



THEME

Night

Night darkens the sky and moonlights the field. Panels, chips and aircraft stay paper-light and accent fills stay bright, so outlines and labels hold.

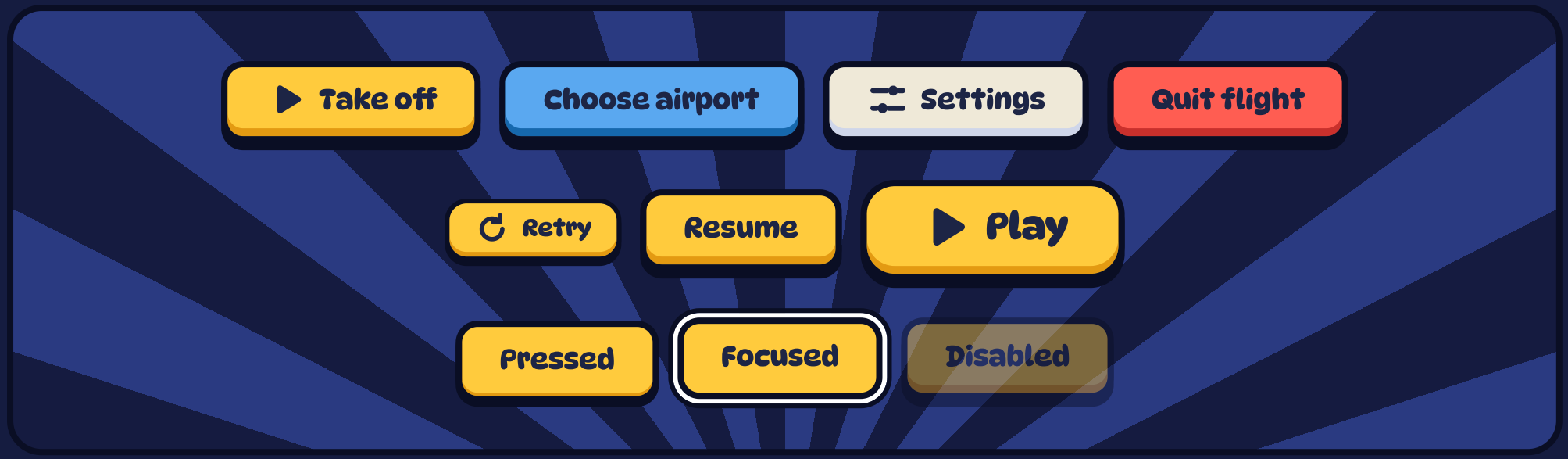
Hud Bar

The gameplay overlay: score and streak on the left, next aircraft, lives and pause on the right.



Button

The chunky toy-block button for every text action in menus and dialogs.



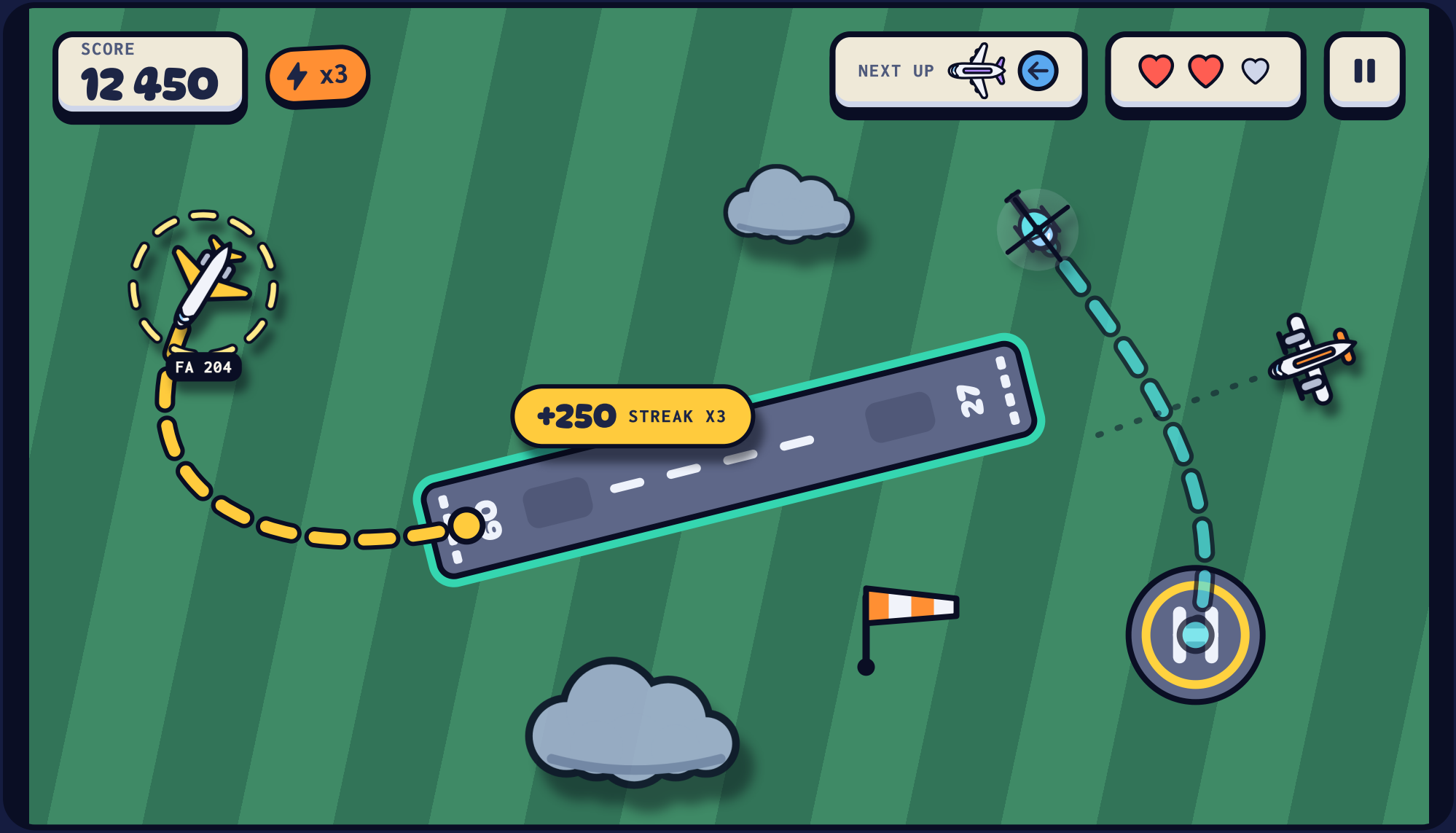
Aircraft

The five flying toys, drawn top-down with the nose pointing up at heading 0.



Game Screen

A reference composition of a game in progress, showing how every world and HUD piece layers.



CONTENT

Voice

A friendly tower controller: short, calm, specific. Sentence case, verbs on buttons, no blame, no emoji.

- ✓ Two aircraft got too close over runway 27.
- ✗ ~~Oops! You crashed!!~~
- ✓ Try again
- ✗ ~~OK~~
- ✓ Missed
- ✗ ~~You failed to land the plane~~
- ✓ Tap an aircraft, then drag to draw its path.
- ✗ ~~Utilise touch input to define a trajectory.~~